

Business Intelligence Overview Report

National Retail Company: Business Intelligence & Interactive Dashboard Development

Dataset: SampleSuperstore Kaggle

Prepared for: AnalystLab Africa Consulting

Date: 11 August 2026

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1. UNDERSTANDING BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE

In today's competitive retail environment, the ability to make quick, smart business decisions has a significant impact, this is why companies are turning into Business Intelligence. Business Intelligence (BI) is the process of collecting, analyzing, and turning raw data into meaningful, actionable information. It uses tools, technologies, and practices such as data warehousing, data mining, reporting, and data visualization to help organization understand past trends, monitor current results and make future predictions. The visual representations created are often called dashboards and common BI tools used for this visualization include Power BI, Tableau, Excel, and Sage reporting modules.

2. WHY ORGANIZATIONS USE DASHBOARDS

Organizations use dashboards because they provide a quick, visual summary of key business data in one place. Specifically, dashboards;

- Display live KPIs without waiting for monthly reports, this helps teams track performance against targets and see where improvements are needed.
- Pull data from different departments into one view, saving time and improving efficiency
- Use charts, graphs, and color-coded indicators to make complex data easy to understand for both technical and non-technical staff, bridging knowledge gaps

3. HOW DASHBOARDS IMPROVE DECISION MAKING

Dashboards turn data into insight, allowing organizations to be more proactive instead of reactive. Some of the proactive ways include;

- Leaders can spot problems or opportunities immediately instead of waiting for periodical reports.
- Managers prioritize, allocate resources better, and measure the impact of decisions quickly.

The importance is not only limited to proactive actions taken but also extends to general functionality of the organizations because;

- By pulling data directly from company systems, dashboards reduce human error from manual reports.
- Dashboards highlight only the most important KPIs, preventing information overload and keeping teams aligned on key goals.

4. BUSINESS OBJECTIVE

The primary objective of the analysis is to gain a clear understanding of the SampleSuperstore dataset to support better decision making for National Retail Company. The investigation will examine key variables including products, regions, categories and customer segments to identify which area the company should prioritize and avoid. The approach will include use of power query for data inspection and data cleaning, identification of relationships and patterns within the data. Findings will be presented through business focused visualizations and interpreted to highlight key insights and potential business risks.

The specific goals are;

- Examine which region has the highest profit and identify which state performs best within each region
- Examine which customer segment performs better
- Identify the most performing shipping mode
- Identify the top-performing product category across regions, as well as the best and worst performing sub-categories overall.
- Examine sales performance across different regions
- Examine the most profitable year and month
- Examine which category has the highest discount rate

5. CONCLUSION

This report sets out to analyze the Superstore dataset to understand what drives sales and profitability for National Retail Company. Addressing these specific goals will provide clear view of where to invest, what to improve, and where risks exist. By implementing a BI dashboard aligned with these objectives, the company can shift from periodic reporting to continuous performance management. This will enable faster responses to market changes and support more confident, data-driven strategic decisions.